# Owen Abel Amenze

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## SUMMARY

Product-minded engineer building AI-assisted discovery and explainable multimodal search. Built Fête Finder's event discovery and partner reporting, and Go APIs and durable jobs for Receipts. At Jisc, led data and search decisions for Open Policy Finder and helped move the main site to serverless infrastructure.

## EXPERIENCE

**Product Engineer (Contract)** – *Out of Office Collective* **London, Mar 2025 - Jun 2026**

Fête Finder

- Built Fête Finder's ticket exchange and bot, sharing site listings with a WhatsApp chat of about 2,000 members.
- Developed agents to scan event and ticketing pages and suggest confidence-scored listings for human review. Reviewers generally accepted the suggestions, with few corrections needed.
- Designed MapLibre location search with geocoding and fallbacks for incomplete venue data.
- Built partner reports tracking ticket clicks and affiliate purchases; the top 10 events had a reported 30% average sales uplift in the two months before Fête de la Musique.

**Senior Software Developer** – *Jisc* **London, Apr 2024 - Feb 2026**

Open Policy Finder · Sherpa Team

- Led a three-developer data team to deliver Open Policy Finder's Next.js MVP after agreeing November scope with product owners.
- Appraised and retired Elasticsearch when PostgreSQL met search needs, removing a separate index synchronisation layer during dataset migration.
- Raised a reported journal-data quality score above 90% over six months with ISSN/eISSN checks, classifiers and deterministic rules.
- Built a data-steward review loop with tracing, reports and an issue runbook, later adopted by other Jisc teams working with similar datasets.

Jisc Website · Digital Experience Team

- Led Jisc's main-site move from outage-prone EC2 containers to AWS Fargate/RDS; observed no further downtime through February 2026 using API/frontend health checks, while reducing cloud spend with scalable compute.
- Made builds less dependent on shared Font Awesome download limits by creating a local npm registry and cache used by multiple Jisc teams.

**Software Engineer (Contract)** – *Contabo GmbH* **Remote, Sep 2020 - Dec 2020**

- Built Go APIs and provisioned infrastructure as code, aligning system configurations to keep systems consistent and reduce failure risk; also improved features and resolved defects with development and QA.

**Software Engineer** – *TempTribe* **London, Jun 2018 - Jun 2020**

- Refactored REST APIs and implemented a scheduling algorithm to reduce shift conflicts.

**Software Developer** – *Hypixel Inc and Dungeon Realms* **United States, May 2016 - Jun 2018**

- Delivered multiplayer game features and payment-flow improvements with QA and design teams.

## SELECTED WORK

**Receipts.beauty** – Find beauty professionals through real work & reviews (private beta) *Lead Engineer*

owenabel.com/work/receipts-discovery

- Developed explainable multimodal search over text and images, with location filters; pgvector surfaces visually similar work, while explanations distinguish similarity from provider claims and reviews.
- Built Go APIs and PostgreSQL workers with generated Protobuf/ConnectRPC contracts for the web app and mobile API client; committed jobs with product changes and used leases and retries for crash recovery.
- Used Zitadel for sign-in and managed revocable sessions and provider-workspace permissions in Go; limited CLI and MCP access to approved actions.
- Implemented a NATS-backed WebSocket gateway for live updates and PostgreSQL replay after reconnects; instrumented APIs and workers with OpenTelemetry traces, metrics and Grafana alerts.
- Wrote a custom Go vet tool that flags misplaced API, authorization, database and background-job code in CI, so human and AI contributors know what to fix before merge.

**Milk & Henny** – Events, stories & games that bring people together *Founder & Host*

owenabel.com/work/milk-and-henny-operations · Play Hot & Cold

- Built Stripe Checkout with signature-checked webhooks for idempotent ticket issuance and PostgreSQL QR admission that prevents duplicate online claims.
- Added passwordless attendee access with one-time email links/codes and passkeys, backed by rotating, revocable sessions and step-up checks for sensitive actions.
- Created Hot & Cold for daily and shared-room play, plus live event games with server-side scoring, shared state and host controls.
- Developed a Cloudflare R2 object storage pipeline: private presigned uploads, processed responsive variants, published galleries, signed original downloads and expiring transfers.

## EDUCATION

**Bachelor (Hons) Computer Science - First Class** **Oct 2020 - Jun 2023**

*University of Essex* Colchester

## SKILLS

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|---|---|
| **Languages** | TypeScript, Go, JavaScript, Python, Java, Bash |
| **Application engineering** | Node.js, React, Next.js, TanStack Start, Django/Wagtail, ConnectRPC |
| **Data & messaging** | PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, Redis, NATS JetStream |
| **Infrastructure** | AWS, Cloudflare, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD |
| **Observability & testing** | OpenTelemetry, Grafana, Vitest, Playwright |

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